



BE READY.

Pre-season

Your sessions

Power + Fitness

Program

Pre-season

Duration

8 weeks

Session

45 to 60 min

Place

Home

For personal use only, do not share. This program is for people in good health: if you feel pain, have an injury or are in doubt, stop and ask a health professional for advice.

Your goals

Power

Power is force multiplied by speed. A jump shot, a duel at pivot or a first step all require producing a lot of force in a fraction of a second.

- **Push heavy:** increase your maximum strength with heavy loads and few reps.
- **Move fast:** turn that strength into fast movements (throws, jumps, pushes).
- **Link the two:** pair a heavy exercise with a similar fast movement (contrast method).

The golden rules

- **Few reps, lots of rest:** 3 to 5 reps, 2 to 3 minutes of recovery.
- **Every rep at maximum speed,** even with a heavy load: the intent is what counts.
- Heavy loads only if your technique is perfect.

At home: the load comes from a weighted backpack (books, water bottles), a handball or a band, and from single-leg variations.

Fitness

During a match, players cover about 4 km on average, alternating walking, running, sprints and contacts (Wagner et al., 2014). What makes the difference at the end of a game is the ability to repeat intense efforts and recover quickly between them.

- **Endurance:** the base that lets you recover between actions.
- **Repeated effort capacity:** stringing sprints together without losing speed.
- **Fat loss:** increasing energy expenditure while keeping your performance.
- **General fitness:** lasting a whole match and a whole season.

The golden rules

- **Progressive:** the volume goes up week after week, never all at once.
- **Stick to the paces:** easy = you can talk; steady = a few words; hard = impossible to talk.
- On repeated sprints, stop the set if your speed drops clearly.

Fat loss: training increases energy expenditure, but the result depends mostly on food and sleep. Avoid restrictive diets, which lower performance. For support, see a registered dietitian.

When three durations are given ("12-15-18 min"), they are for levels 1, 2 and 3.



Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it. Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

How to read your sessions

- Every session is written out in full, in order: do the steps from top to bottom.
- "2-4 × 8": 2 sets at level 1, 3 at level 2, 4 at level 3, of 8 reps. "2-3 × 8": 2 sets at levels 1 and 2, 3 at level 3.
- The number in front of each exercise refers to its illustrated sheet, at the end of this document.
- If you do not know your level, read the guide again, page "Choosing your level".

Weeks 1-2 · Getting started

Get your body used to effort again and learn the movements. Effort 5-6 out of 10.

Power: moderate loads to learn the movements, light throws.

Fitness: build your endurance base, gently.

Session A

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

9	 Squat	2-3 × 9 · 3 s descent	2 min
10	 Two-handed ball throw	2-3 × 5	60 s

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

11	Easy run	12-15-18 min	
12	 High knees	4 × 15 m	walk back

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

5	 Plank	2-4 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2-3 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2-3 × 4	60 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session B

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

15	 Hip thrust	2-3 × 12	90 s
16	 Rotational throw	2 × 5 per side	60 s

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

17	 Circuit training	2-3 rounds	90 s between rounds
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4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

18	 Dead bug	2-3 × 8 per side	30 s
19	 Y-T-W	2-3 × 8	30 s
20	 Balance with a ball	2 × 30 s per leg	20 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session C

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

21	 Weighted push-ups	2-3 × 12	2 min
22	 Box jump	2-3 × 4	75 s

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

11	Easy run	10-12-15 min	
23	15-15 intervals (introduction)	4-5-6 min	

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

24	 Single-leg glute bridge	2-3 × 10 per leg	30 s
25	 Copenhagen plank (knee version)	2-3 × 15 s per side	30 s
26	 Shoulder external rotation	2-3 × 12 per arm	30 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Week after week, you can add the optional bonus session:

Session D (bonus, optional) - 20 min

1 WARM-UP

10 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 PREVENTION AND MOBILITY

10 min

5	 Plank	2 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2 × 3	60 s
27	 90/90 hip mobility	1 × 8 per side	
28	 Ankle mobility at the wall	1 × 10 per side	
29	 Upper back rotation	1 × 8 per side	

Weeks 3-5 - Building up

Increase the loads gradually. Week 5 is the heaviest. Effort 7-8 out of 10.

Power: this is the phase where you push heavy, increase the loads every week.

Fitness: intervals come in.

Session A

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

30	 Weighted Bulgarian split squat	3-4 × 8-10 per leg · 3 s descent	3 min
10	 Two-handed ball throw	3 × 5	75 s

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

23	15-15 intervals	2 × 6-7-8 min	3 min between blocks
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4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

5	 Plank	2-4 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2-3 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2-3 × 4	60 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session B

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

31	Single-leg hip thrust	3-4 × 10 per leg · 2 s pause at the top	2 min
32	Inverted row, feet raised	3 × 7	2 min
16	Rotational throw	3 × 4 per side	60 s

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

17	Circuit training	3-4 rounds	90 s between rounds
33	Handball shuttles	4 × 30 s	30 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

18	Dead bug	2-3 × 8 per side	30 s
19	Y-T-W	2-3 × 8	30 s
20	Balance with a ball	2 × 30 s per leg	20 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session C

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

21	 Weighted push-ups	3-4 × 8-10	3 min
22	 Box jump	3 × 4	90 s

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

11	Easy run	15-18-20 min	
34	30-30 intervals	6-8-10 reps	

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

24	 Single-leg glute bridge	2-3 × 10 per leg	30 s
25	 Copenhagen plank (knee version)	2-3 × 15 s per side	30 s
26	 Shoulder external rotation	2-3 × 12 per arm	30 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Weeks 6-7 · Intensity

Less volume, more speed: every rep at maximum quality. Effort 7-8 out of 10.

Power: every heavy set is followed straight away by an explosive movement (contrast).

Fitness: short, repeated efforts, like in a match.

Session A

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

30	 Weighted Bulgarian split squat	3 × 6 per leg · 3 s descent	back to back
35	 Loaded squat jump	3 × 4	3 min after the pair

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

36	Repeated sprints	2-3 sets	3 min
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4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

5	 Plank	2-4 × 30 s	30 s
13	 Side plank	2-3 × 20 s per side	20 s
14	 Nordic hamstring curl	2-3 × 4	60 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session B

1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back

2 POWER

15-20 min

21	 Weighted push-ups	3 × 6	back to back
37	 Plyometric push-ups	3 × 4	3 min after the pair

3 FITNESS

15-20 min

23	15-15 intervals	2 × 8 min	3 min
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4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

18	 Dead bug	2-3 × 8 per side	30 s
19	 Y-T-W	2-3 × 8	30 s
20	 Balance with a ball	2 × 30 s per leg	20 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session C

1 WARM-UP		10-12 min	
1	Light jog and running drills	3 min	
2	 Forward lunge with trunk rotation	6 per side	
3	 Walking hip opener	8 per side	
4	 Glute bridge	2 × 10	15 s
5	 Plank	2 × 20 s	15 s
6	 Single-leg balance	2 × 20 s per leg	
7	 Small jump, stable landing	2 × 5	20 s
8	Progressive accelerations	3 runs	walk back
2 POWER		15-20 min	
38	 Overhead throw	3 × 4	75 s
16	 Rotational throw	3 × 4 per side	75 s
22	 Box jump	3 × 3	90 s
3 FITNESS		15-20 min	
33	Handball shuttles	6 × 30 s	30 s
11	Easy run (recovery)	10 min	
4 CORE AND PREVENTION		5-8 min	
24	 Single-leg glute bridge	2-3 × 10 per leg	30 s
25	 Copenhagen plank (knee version)	2-3 × 15 s per side	30 s
26	 Shoulder external rotation	2-3 × 12 per arm	30 s
5 COOL-DOWN		5 min	
2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.			

Week 8 - Taper

Repeat sessions A, B and C from weeks 6-7 doing **half the sets**, at the same intensity. You will start the season with your club in top shape.

- **Power:** Same loads, same speed.
- **Fitness:** Halve the duration or the number of sets, keep the intensity.

The exercises

In the order of the numbers used in your sessions.



Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it. Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

1 Light jog and running drills

Light jog, alternating side shuffles, high knees and butt kicks.

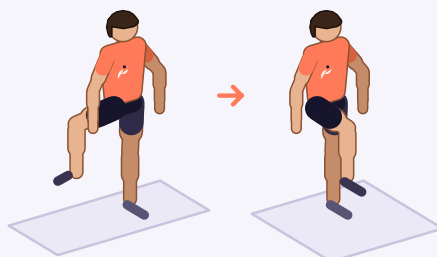
Key points: Start slowly, then gradually pick up the pace.



2 Forward lunge with trunk rotation

Arms straight out in front of you, take a big step forward and lower into a lunge, then turn your trunk and arms towards the front leg. Come back and switch legs.

Key points: Front knee above the ankle, slow rotation.



3 Walking hip opener

On the spot or walking: lift your knee out to the side as if stepping over a fence, bring it round in front of you at the same height, then put your foot down. Switch legs.

Key points: Upright trunk, big circle with the knee.



4



Glute bridge

On your back, knees bent, feet on the floor, lift your hips until shoulders, hips and knees are in line, then lower.

Key points: Squeeze your glutes at the top, do not arch your lower back. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.



5



Plank

On your forearms and toes, body in a straight line from head to heels.

Key points: Squeeze your glutes and abs, breathe normally.

Easier: Knees on the floor.



6



Single-leg balance

On one foot, knee slightly bent, the other foot off the floor behind you, arms relaxed: hold the position without moving. To progress: close your eyes, then stand on a cushion.

Key points: The knee stays over the foot, the pelvis level.



7



Small jump, stable landing

Small jump on the spot, land softly on both feet and hold the position for 2 seconds.

Key points: Land on the balls of your feet, knees bent and in line with your toes: they never cave inwards. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

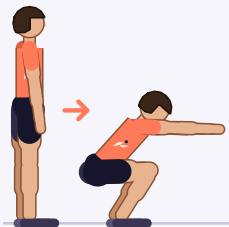
8

Progressive accelerations

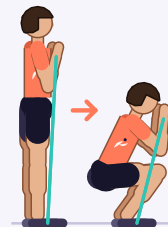
Run 15 m, building up speed: 60 %, then 80 %, then 90 % of your top speed. Walk back.

Key points: Relaxed, shoulders loose.

At home



With a band



9



Squat

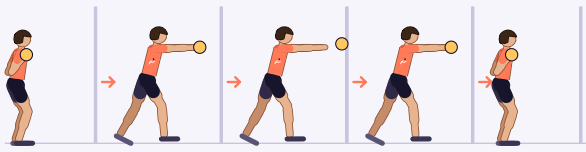
Feet shoulder-width apart, arms straight out in front, lower as if sitting down, thighs at least parallel to the floor, then stand up. When it gets easy: a weighted backpack held tight against your chest.

With a band: Band under your feet, held at your shoulders: it resists as you stand up.

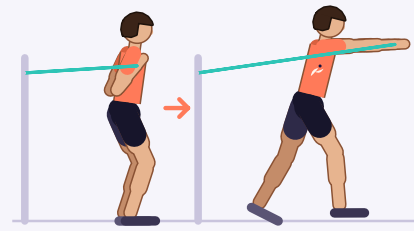
Key points: Straight back, heels on the floor, knees in line with your feet.

Easier: Sit down on a chair and stand up.

At home



With a band



10 Two-handed ball throw

Facing an outside wall, handball or basketball at your chest, throw as hard as you can. Without a ball: plyometric push-ups.

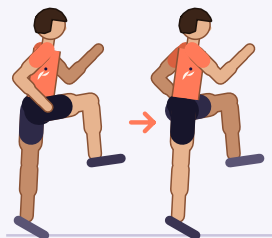
With a band: Band anchored behind you at chest height: push forward as fast as possible.

Key points: Push with your legs and arms at the same time.

11 Easy run

Continuous running at a pace where you can hold a conversation.

Key points: If you cannot talk, slow down or alternate running and walking.



12 High knees

Over 15 m moving forward (or on the spot), drive your knees up quickly.

Key points: On the balls of your feet, active arms.



13 Side plank

On your side, on your forearm (elbow under the shoulder) and the edge of your foot, body in line, hips high, top arm reaching up to the ceiling.

Key points: The hips do not drop.

Easier: Knees on the floor.

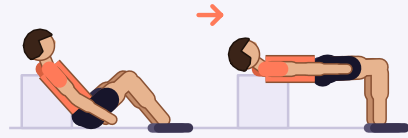


14 Nordic hamstring curl

Kneeling on a cushion, feet anchored under the sofa or held by another person, lean forward as slowly as possible, body straight. Catch yourself with your hands, then push back up with your hands.

Key points: Hips extended: the body stays straight from the knees to the head.

Easier: Shorter descent.



15 Hip thrust

Upper back against the sofa, feet on the floor, lift your hips until shoulders, hips and knees are in line. When it gets easy: on one leg.

With a band: Band across your hips, held to the floor by your hands on each side.

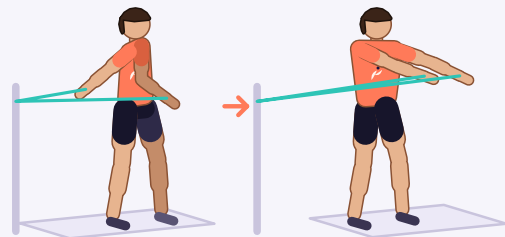
Key points: Squeeze your glutes at the top for one second. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.

Easier: Glute bridge on the floor.

At home



With a band



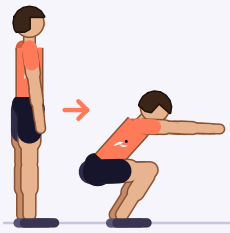
16 Rotational throw

Side-on to an outside wall, ball held at your hip, pivot and throw sideways, like a shot. Without a ball: fast trunk rotations, arms straight.

With a band: Band anchored to the side at hip height: rotate your trunk as fast as possible, pulling the band.

Key points: The movement starts from the hips, not the arms.

Squats



Push-ups



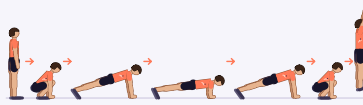
Alternating lunges



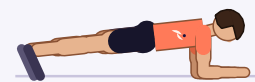
Mountain climbers



Burpees



Plank

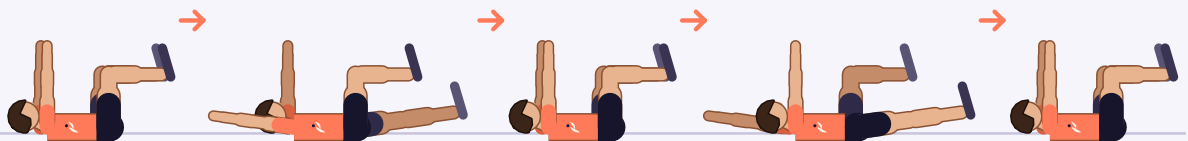


17 Circuit training

30 seconds of each exercise in a row: squats, push-ups, alternating lunges, mountain climbers, burpees, plank.

Key points: Quality of movement before speed.

Easier: 20 seconds of work, 10 seconds of rest.



18 Dead bug

On your back, arms straight up towards the ceiling, knees bent at 90°. Extend one arm and the opposite leg without touching the floor, then switch sides.

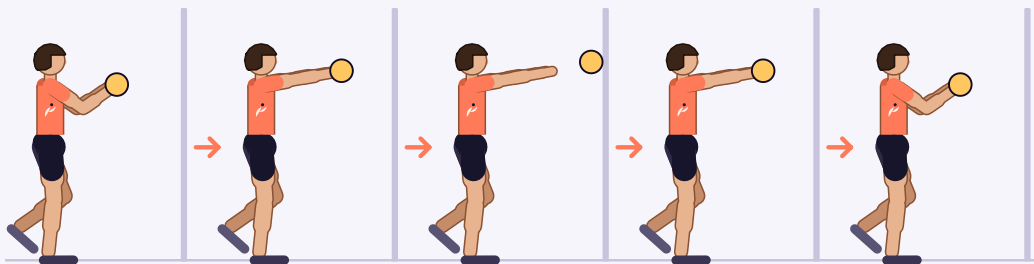
Key points: Your lower back stays pressed to the floor.



19 Y-T-W

Lying face down, forehead on a towel. Lift your arms off the floor to draw three letters with your body: Y (arms straight, diagonally above your head), T (arms out to the sides), then W (elbows bent, pulled in close to your ribs). Hold each letter for 2 seconds, squeezing your shoulder blades.

Key points: Thumbs towards the ceiling, no arching.



20 Balance with a ball

On one leg, throw a ball against a wall and catch it. Harder: standing on a folded cushion.

Key points: The standing knee stays in line.

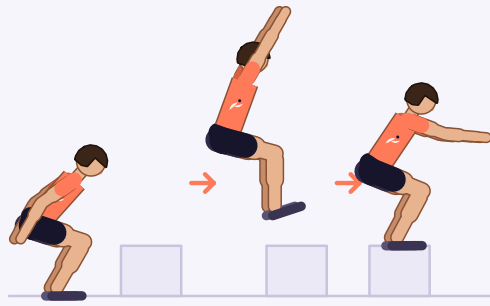


21 Weighted push-ups

Push-ups with a weighted backpack. Without a bag: feet raised, 3-second descent.

With a band: Push-ups with a strong band across your back.

Key points: Shoulder blades squeezed, explosive push.



22 Box jump

Jump onto a stair step or a very stable bench, land softly, step back down. Without a stable support: squat jump.

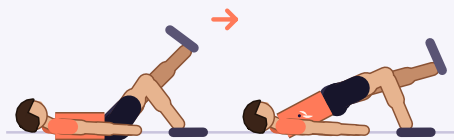
Key points: Jump high, not far. Stepping down protects your tendons. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

23 15-15 intervals

15 seconds of fast running, 15 seconds of walking or very slow jogging, continuously.

Key points: Same distance on every rep: pick a finish point.

Easier: 15 seconds fast, 30 seconds of recovery.



24 Single-leg glute bridge

Like the glute bridge, with one leg straight in the air.

Key points: The pelvis stays level. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.



25 Copenhagen plank

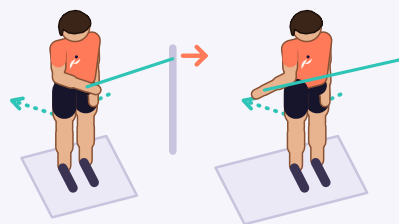
On your side, on your forearm (elbow under the shoulder), top leg resting on the sofa or a chair (at the knee, or at the foot to make it harder). Lift your hips, reach your top arm up to the ceiling and hold the position.

Key points: Body in line: the inside of the top thigh does the work.

At home



With a band



26 Shoulder external rotation

Lying on your side, top elbow tucked against your waist and bent at 90°, a water bottle in your hand, forearm resting in front of your belly: lift your forearm towards the ceiling by pivoting around the elbow (the hand moves away from your belly), then lower slowly.

With a band: Standing, band anchored to the side: elbow tucked in, move your forearm outwards.

Key points: The elbow does not move, 2 seconds on the way back.

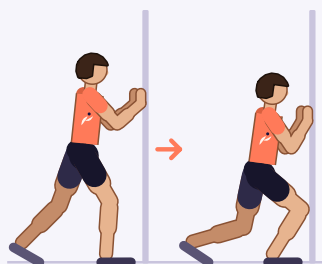
Easier: Without a band.



27 90/90 hip mobility

Seated on the floor, hands on the floor behind you, feet flat and wider than your hips, knees up. Let both knees drop to the same side into the 90/90 position: front leg bent at 90° in front of you, back leg bent at 90° out to the side. Bring the knees back up through the middle and over to the other side, like windscreen wipers.

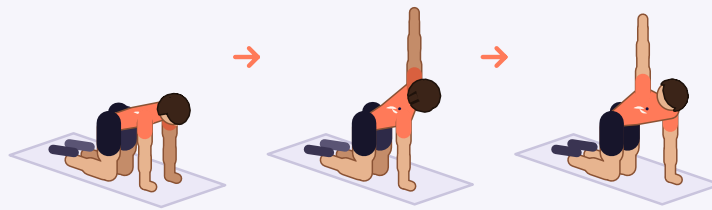
Key points: Upright trunk, slow movement. Only go as far as your hips allow, pain-free.



28 Ankle mobility at the wall

Facing a wall, hands on it, front foot 10 cm from the wall and the other foot behind: drive your front knee forward to touch the wall without lifting your heel.

Key points: Heel glued to the floor. Move your foot back if it is easy.



29 Upper back rotation

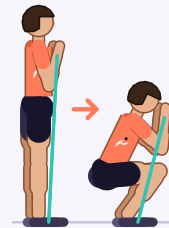
On all fours, hands under your shoulders. Rotate your upper back as you reach one arm towards the ceiling, following your hand with your eyes, then bring it back down and do the same with the other arm.

Key points: The pelvis does not move.

At home



With a band

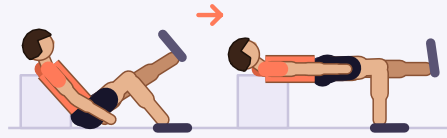


30 Weighted Bulgarian split squat

Back foot resting on the sofa or a chair, weighted backpack on your back: lower on the front leg over 3 seconds, then stand up as fast as possible.

With a band: Squat with a strong band under your feet, held at your shoulders, 2-second pause at the bottom.

Key points: Controlled descent, stand up as fast as possible.



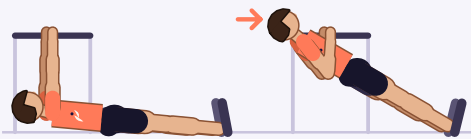
31 Single-leg hip thrust

Upper back on the sofa, one leg straight in the air: drive your hips up forcefully and hold for 2 seconds at the top.

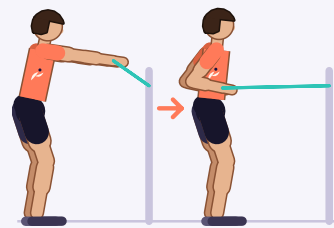
With a band: On both legs, strong band across your hips, pause at the top.

Key points: Push through your heels, lock your glutes at the top. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.

At home



With a band



32 Inverted row, feet raised

Under a sturdy table, feet on a chair: pull your chest quickly towards the table, lower over 3 seconds.

With a band: Row with a strong band anchored to a door, 1-second pause with the elbows back.

Key points: Pull fast, lower slowly.

33 Handball shuttles

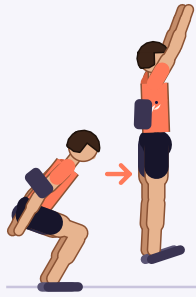
Back and forth between two lines 10 m apart: forwards, side shuffling and backwards.

Key points: Stay low in the changes of direction.

34 30-30 intervals

30 seconds fast (you can only say a few words), 30 seconds of jogging.

Key points: Steady pace from one rep to the next.



35 Loaded squat jump

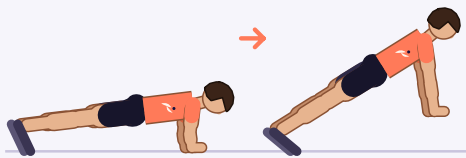
Squat jump with a light backpack (3 to 5 kg). Without a bag: normal squat jump.

Key points: Stable landing, knees in line. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

36 Repeated sprints

6 sprints of 20 m. You go again every 20 seconds: the time left is for walking back.

Key points: Every sprint flat out.

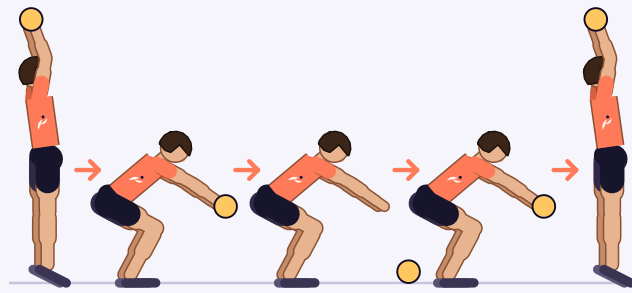


37 Plyometric push-ups

Push hard enough for your hands to leave the floor on every rep.

Key points: Land with your arms slightly bent.

Easier: Hands on a bench.



38



Overhead throw

Handball or basketball above your head, slam it hard into the floor in front of you as you bend your legs, then catch it on the bounce.

Key points: Your whole body takes part, tight core.